Malware & Ransomware Attacks on Systems

Five Real-World Case Studies

Servers, corporates, hospitals, banks and government bodies – India and worldwide

Overview of the five cases

#	Case	Date	Region	Reported loss
1	WannaCry ransomware (NHS and 150 countries)	May 2017	Worldwide / UK	About £92 million for the NHS alone
2	NotPetya on Maersk	June 2017	Worldwide	$250–300 million for Maersk
3	Colonial Pipeline (DarkSide)	May 2021	USA	$4.4 million ransom paid; fuel supply halted
4	AIIMS Delhi ransomware	Nov 2022	India	Hospital services on manual mode for days; no official cost published
5	Cosmos Bank, Pune	Aug 2018	India	₹94.42 crore (about $13.5 million)

Note: Figures are as reported by the news articles and official reports listed under each case. Where a recovery cost was never officially published, this is stated instead of guessing.

Case 1: WannaCry Ransomware (2017)

Date / timing	Started 12 May 2017; spread within a day; slowed on 13 May 2017 when a kill switch was activated.
Victims	Over 200,000 computers in about 150 countries, including the UK National Health Service (NHS), FedEx, Honda, Renault, Nissan UK and Telefonica.
Type of attack	Self-spreading ransomware worm. Files were locked and a Bitcoin ransom was demanded.
Cause	Exploited a critical vulnerability in Microsoft Windows for which a patch existed but had not been applied on many machines. Outdated systems and slow patching at the NHS made it spread easily. The malware was not aimed only at the NHS; it spread to anything vulnerable.
Loss	About 80 NHS hospital trusts and 8% of GP practices disrupted; around 19,000 appointments cancelled in one week.
Recovery	British researcher Marcus Hutchins found an unregistered web domain inside the malware and registered it, which acted as a kill switch and stopped it spreading. Affected organisations then patched Windows and restored systems.
Recovery cost	An estimated £92 million for the NHS (lost services plus IT costs afterwards), per a UK Department of Health report. This is a rough estimate.
Solution / lessons	Apply security patches quickly; replace unsupported operating systems. Keep offline backups and segment networks so one infection cannot reach everything. UK and US governments later blamed North Korea.

What happened

On 12 May 2017 the WannaCry worm began infecting Windows computers worldwide. Users saw red-lettered messages demanding Bitcoin to unlock their files. In England, hospitals had to cancel operations and appointments and divert patients.

The spread was slowed by a researcher who noticed an unusual domain name in the code and registered it. Experts warned that versions without a kill switch could be made, so patching remained the real long-term fix.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **National Health Executive: WannaCry cost the NHS £92m –** https://www.nationalhealthexecutive.com/articles/wannacry-cyber-attack-cost-nhs-ps92m-after-19000-appointments-were-cancelled
- **The Washington Times (11 Oct 2018): UK Department of Health report –** https://www.washingtontimes.com/news/2018/oct/11/wannacry-cyberattack-cost-british-government-over-/
- **The Open University: What was the attack? –** https://www.open.edu/openlearn/digital-computing/learning-major-cyber-security-incidents/content-section-2.1

Article screenshot / photo:

hindustan times

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THE GLOBAL CHRONICLE LONDON SATURDAY, MAY 13, 2017

GLOBAL CYBER BLITZKRIEG: NHS HOSPITALS PARALYZED 150 Nations Hit by 'WannaCry' Ransomware; Surgeries Halted Across Britain

PHOTO / GRAPHIC: Inset of Red "Wana Decrypt0r 2.0" Bitcoin Ransom Screen "Your files are encrypted! Payment will be raised in 3 days: $300 in Bitcoin"

— LONDON In what cybersecurity officials call the largest coordinated malware strike in modern history, critical infrastructure across 150 nations ground to a halt yesterday after an automated worm weaponized a leaked Windows flaw.

England's National Health Service bore the brunt of the chaos. Over 80 hospital trusts were forced into blackout conditions, canceling 19,000 appointments and diverting ambulances as computer monitors locked in unison.

International Moose Count Underway

By BOB O'BOBSTON

The UN-sponsored International Moose Census got off to a flying start today with hopes for an increase in the worldwide moose population compared to last year's disapointing figures. Among the traditional early reporters were Egypt, returning figures of six moose, a twenty percent

According to Robbie McRobson, head of the UN Moose Preservation Council, worldwide moose numbers are expected to grow markedly on last year due to the traditional moose strongholds of Canada and the United States, with the larger developing moose ecologies also poised to make gains. The largest percentagege increase in moose will likely come from China'', says McRobson, The Chinese government has invested heavily in moose infrastructure over the past decade, and their committment to macrofauna is beginning to pay dividends''. Since 2004 China has expanded moose pasture from 1.5% of arable land to nearly 3.648% and moose numbers are expected to rise to 60,000 making China a net moose exporter for the first time. This is good news for neighbouring Mongolia, a barren moose-wasteland whose inhabitents nonetheless have an insatiable desire for the creatures. The increase in Beijing-Ulanbataar trade is anticipated to relieve pressure on the relatively strained Russian suppliers, but increase Mongolia's imbalance of trade with its larger neighbour.

Historically the only competitor to China in the far eastern moose markets has been Singapore but the tiny island nation is set to report a net loss, expecting a decrease of more than five percent on last year's 50,000 moose counted. The head of Singapore's Agency for Agriculture, Jing-Feng Lau, explained to an incredulous Singaporean parliament yesterday that bad weather had contributed to this season's poor showing, most notably when a cargo of 150 moose were swept out into the Indian ocean in a monsoon.

Yet again the global demand for moose will be met largely by the US and Canada. The recession-hit States is taking comfort in its moose growth figures with gross production expected to break 700,000 and net exmoose population expected to match last year's record figures of one hundred million billion.

Europe's rise as an international moose power will slow slightly this year as a response to the European Union's move towards standardising the European moose. Stringent quality controls are holding back the development of the eastern european populations compared to last year when they contributed significantly to europe's strong growth figures. Norway, which is not an EU member but has observer status, strengthed in numbers relative to the Euro area with numbers of Norweigian moose, known locally as elk'' expected to rise for the tenth consecutive year, particularly thanks to a strong showing in the last quarter.

As moose season reaches its close, researchers world wide are turning to science in an attempt to boost next year's figures. NASA stunned the scientific community today with the announcment of their discovery that the moon is significantly smaller than previously believed. This conclusion, which is the conclusion of a ten-year collaborative project, will have profound implications for the moose community as the gravitational field is now known to be of the right strength to support moose in orbit.

According to John Johnson, head of the NASA Moon Sizing Experiment the first delivery of moose into low moon orbit could be achieved as early as the third quarter of next year. The technology to nurture moose in space is available now'', he said, ''all that is needed is political will''.

Granny wins World Wrestling Championship

By ROY MCROYSTON

Case 2: NotPetya Attack on Maersk (2017)

Date / timing	27 June 2017 (malware was planted in a software update on 22 June 2017).
Victim	A.P. Moller–Maersk, the world's largest container shipping company, along with many other global firms (for example Merck and FedEx TNT).
Type of attack	Destructive malware that looked like ransomware (a 'wiper').
Cause	Attackers compromised the update server of Ukrainian accounting software M.E.Doc and pushed NotPetya out as a trusted update. It then spread inside networks using the same Windows weakness as WannaCry plus stolen passwords. US, UK and other governments attributed it to Russian military intelligence (GRU).
Loss	Maersk lost almost its entire global IT system within hours, including domain controllers. About 80% of shipping volume had to be handled manually for ten days. Many port terminals were disrupted.
Recovery	One domain controller in Maersk's Ghana office survived because a power cut had taken it offline before the attack. It was used to rebuild the network. Maersk reinstalled about 4,000 servers, 45,000 PCs and 2,500 applications in around ten days, work that would normally take about six months.
Recovery cost	Maersk estimated total damage at $250–300 million. Total NotPetya damage across all victims is estimated at over $10 billion.
Solution / lessons	Maersk's chairman said the company found it was only average in cybersecurity and set out to improve it. Key lessons: patching, network segmentation, protected backups of domain controllers, and checking updates from software suppliers.

What happened

NotPetya was aimed at Ukraine, but it spread worldwide through company networks that had offices there. Maersk's ships kept moving, but port and booking systems went down. Staff worked with paper and phones while engineers rebuilt the IT estate.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **SC Media: NotPetya attack totally destroyed Maersk's computer network –** https://scmagazine.com/news/notpetya-attack-totally-destroyed-maersks-computer-network-chairman
- **Supply Chain Dive: Maersk's recovery after Nyetya –** https://www.supplychaindive.com/news/ocean-shipping-maersk-herculean-resilience-malware-devastation-nyetya-infrastructure/518494
- **Control Engineering: The NotPetya attack that took down Maersk –** https://www.controleng.com/?p=123809

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By JOHN

MARITIME & FINANCIAL DISPATCH COPENHAGEN WEDNESDAY, JUNE 28, 2017

GLOBAL TRADE AT A STANDSTILL AS MAERSK HIT BY 'NOTPETYA' Wiper Disguised as Ransomware Wipes Out World's Largest Shipping Carrier

PHOTO: Gridlock at Rotterdam Terminal Gates with Handwritten Outage Signs "DO NOT TURN OFF PC: Entire fleet tracking and terminal gates knocked dark"

COPENHAGEN

The gears of international commerce came to an abrupt freeze after an aggressive cyber weapon, dubbed 'NotPetya', decimated corporate networks worldwide, striking shipping giant A.P. Moller-Maersk at its core.

The malware entered through a compromised Ukrainian accounting update and obliterated domain controllers across continents in minutes.

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Case 3: Colonial Pipeline Ransomware (2021)

Date / timing	Attack detected 7 May 2021; the company shut down its pipeline the same day and it was offline for several days.
Victim	Colonial Pipeline, the largest fuel pipeline in the USA, supplying roughly half the fuel used on the East Coast.
Type of attack	Ransomware by the DarkSide group (Russia-linked).
Cause	Attackers entered through a single compromised VPN password, according to the security firm Mandiant. A control room employee found a ransom note on screen.
Loss	Fuel supply along the East Coast was disrupted. Colonial shut the pipeline to stop the attack reaching its operating systems.
Recovery	Colonial paid about $4.4 million (75 Bitcoin) and received a decryption key to restart faster.
Recovery cost	The $4.4 million ransom. On 7 June 2021 the US Justice Department said the FBI recovered about $2.3 million of it (63.7 Bitcoin) by getting access to the attackers' Bitcoin wallet.
Solution / lessons	Use multi-factor authentication on remote access such as VPNs; remove unused accounts. Report attacks to law enforcement quickly; the FBI generally advises against paying ransoms.

What happened

The attack hit Colonial's business IT systems, and the company took its pipeline offline as a precaution. The incident led to public panic buying of fuel in parts of the USA and became a turning point in how governments treat ransomware.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **TechTarget: FBI seized Colonial Pipeline ransom from DarkSide affiliate –** https://www.techtarget.com/cybersecurity/news/252513302/FBI-seized-Colonial-Pipeline-ransom-from-DarkSide-affiliate
- **Computing.co.uk: US recovers most of ransom paid to Colonial Pipeline hackers –** https://www.computing.co.uk/news/4032526/us-recovers-most-usd-million-ransom-paid-colonial-pipeline-hackers
- **PBS NewsHour / AP: Department of Justice officials discuss Colonial Pipeline –** https://www.pbs.org/newshour/nation/watch-live-department-of-justice-officials-discuss-colonial-pipeline-ransomware-attack

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By JACK PUAL

THE WASHINGTON POST-STANDARD ATLANTA MONDAY, MAY 10, 2021

EAST COAST FUEL ARTERY SHUTTERED IN MASSIVE RANSOMWARE HEIST Colonial Pipeline Halts 5,500-Mile Network; Panic Buying Hits Gas Stations

PHOTO: Drivers Queue at Dry Gas Station; Yellow Out-of-Order Bags on Pumps "DarkSide Syndicate Breached Systems via Single Stolen VPN Password"

WASHINGTON Emergency measures were declared across the Southeastern United States after the country's most vital fuel pipeline was taken offline following an extortion attack by the Russian-speaking syndicate 'DarkSide'.

Supplying nearly 45% of East Coast petroleum, the pipeline was severed to prevent attackers from crossing into operational systems. Panicked motorists rushed to service stations, creating widespread shortages along the seaboard.

International Moose Count

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Case 4: AIIMS Delhi Ransomware Attack (India, 2022)

Date / timing	23 November 2022. First sign at about 6:45–7:00 am when the emergency lab could not view reports.
Victim	All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi, a major government hospital.
Type of attack	Suspected ransomware on the e-Hospital system run by the National Informatics Centre (NIC).
Cause	Ransomware infected the e-Hospital and Laboratory Information System servers. Infected files changed extensions, which pointed to ransomware. A government source reported to ANI that the attack originated in China and that 5 physical servers out of 100 (40 physical, 60 virtual) were infiltrated. This is an official-source claim reported by media.
Loss	Appointments, billing, smart lab and report generation went offline; OPD, IPD and labs ran manually for days. Reports said data of up to 40 million patients might have been exposed (reported as a possibility, not confirmed).
Recovery	Delhi Police registered a case of extortion and cyber terrorism on 25 November 2022 (IFSO unit). CERT-In, NIA, CBI and IB also probed. Data was restored from backups onto new, scanned servers by 29–30 November; the network was sanitised before services resumed. Infected servers were physically removed on police instructions. Online OPD registration resumed around 6 December 2022.
Recovery cost	No official figure for the recovery cost has been published. Media reports of a ₹200 crore crypto demand were denied by Delhi Police.
Solution / lessons	Maintain offline or separate backups; the e-Hospital backup was restored from a replica. Regular security audits and network segmentation for hospital systems.

What happened

Staff first noticed the problem when lab reports would not open. Within hours the e-Hospital servers were down and the hospital switched to paper records. Investigators from several agencies took part, and services were brought back in stages over about two weeks.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **Scroll.in: How AIIMS is working to restore services after the cyberattack –** https://scroll.in/latest/1038702/how-aiims-is-working-to-restore-services-after-hackers-crippled-its-computer-systems
- **Healthcare IT News: AIIMS Delhi restores e-hospital server data –** https://www.healthcareitnews.com/news/asia/aiims-delhi-restores-e-hospital-server-data
- **The Pioneer (PTI): Online registration of OPD patients resumes at AIIMS-Delhi –** https://www.dailypioneer.com/2022/top-stories/online-registration-of-opd-patients-resumes-at-aiims-delhi.html
- **Deccan Herald (PTI): AIIMS server down, agencies probe, FIR filed –** https://www.deccanherald.com/amp/story/india%2Faiims-server-down-various-agencies-looking-into-incident-delhi-police-file-fir-1165511.html

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By PRAYAGRAJ SHARMA

THE CAPITAL DAILY NEW DELHI FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 25, 2022

AIIMS SERVERS CRIPPLED BY RANSOMWARE; HOSPITALS REVERT TO PAPER Premier Medical Institute Paralyzed; Police IFSO Unit Launches Cyber Terror Probe —

PHOTO: Stacks of Handwritten Files and Massive Queues Outside AIIMS OPD "e-Hospital system down; records of up to 40 million patients compromised"

NEW DELHI A severe cyberattack has crippled the digital backbone of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), forcing the apex medical centre to shift all patient registrations, billing, and lab diagnostics to manual registers.

The breach, which knocked out the National Informatics Centre (NIC) e-Hospital servers, left thou-

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Case 5: Cosmos Bank Malware Attack, Pune (India, 2018)

Date / timing	11 August 2018 (ATM card withdrawals) and 13 August 2018 (SWIFT transfers).
Victim	Cosmos Co-operative Bank, Pune, one of India's oldest and biggest co-operative banks.
Type of attack	Malware on the bank's ATM switch server, followed by fraudulent SWIFT transfers.
Cause	Malware on the ATM switch server stole details of Visa and RuPay debit cards. According to the FIR, a proxy switch was created so that fraudulent payments were approved by the attackers' own system instead of the real network. The core banking system was not attacked, according to the bank.
Loss	₹94.42 crore (about $13.5 million) in total. About ₹78 crore through more than 12,000 Visa card transactions in 28 countries; about ₹2.5 crore from 2,849 transactions in India; and ₹13.92 crore sent by SWIFT to ALM Trading Ltd at Hang Seng Bank, Hong Kong.
Recovery	Visa flagged the suspicious transactions. The bank shut its Visa/RuPay payment system, net banking and servers, filed an FIR at Chatushringi police station and hired a forensic agency. Police arrested at least 18 people, mainly money mules. In April 2023 a Pune court convicted 11 people (reported by Business Standard).
Recovery cost	The bank said no customer accounts were affected and that the bank bore the loss itself. Police recovered some money from customers who withdrew excess balances during the attack. A full recovery figure has not been published.
Solution / lessons	Monitor card transactions in real time; secure and separate ATM switch servers. FBI had warned banks days earlier about a coordinated ATM cash-out threat, so alerts need quick action.

What happened

For about two hours on 11 August the bank saw repeated unusual transactions on Visa and RuPay cards across ATMs worldwide. Two days later the attackers also tried SWIFT transfers to Hong Kong. The case is among India's biggest bank cyber thefts.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **Hindustan Times / PressReader (15 Aug 2018): ₹94 crore stolen as gang hacks Pune bank –** https://www.pressreader.com/india/hindustan-times-lucknow/20180815/281848644440575
- **Moneylife (IANS): Hackers transfer Rs94 crore from Pune's Cosmos Bank –** https://www.moneylife.in/article/hackers-transfer-rs94-crore-from-punes-cosmos-bank/55022.html
- **Business Today: Cosmos Bank ATM server hacked –** https://www.businesstoday.in/amp/industry/banks/story/pune-cosmos-bank-atm-server-hacked-rs-94-crore-transferred-to-overseas-accounts-109361-2018-08-14
- **Business Standard: Cosmos Bank fraud (conviction report, April 2023) –** https://business-standard.com/amp/topic/cosmos-bank-fraud

Conclusion: Common causes and common fixes

Across all five cases, the same weaknesses appear again and again:

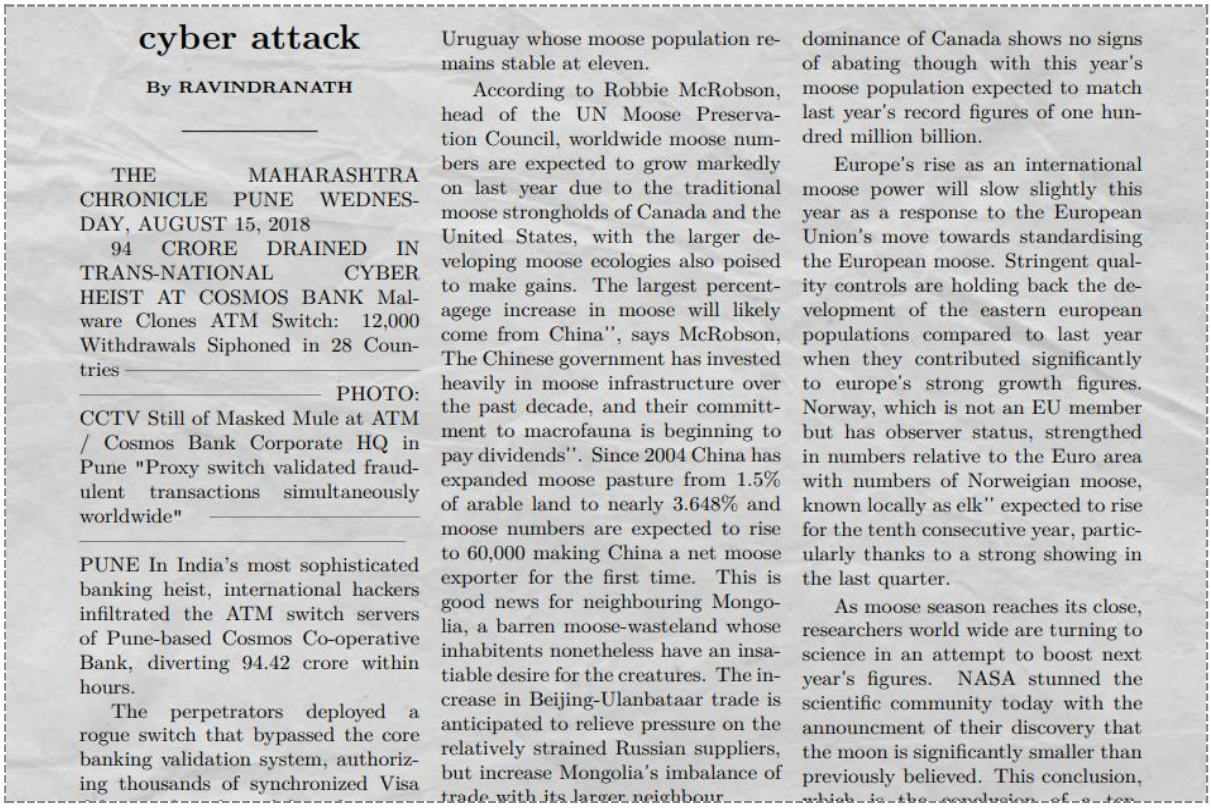
- Unpatched or outdated software (WannaCry, NotPetya).
- Weak access control, such as one stolen VPN password (Colonial Pipeline).
- Poorly separated networks that let one infection reach everything (Maersk, AIIMS).
- Slow detection of unusual activity (Cosmos Bank).

The most effective defences are regular patching, multi-factor authentication, tested offline backups, network segmentation, 24x7 monitoring, and a rehearsed incident response plan.

Important note for submission

- The dashed boxes in each case are for you to paste a screenshot of the original article. Open the link under 'Proof of source', take a screenshot of the headline and date, and paste it in. Do not paste whole articles; keep the screenshot as a small proof image and keep the links.

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By RAVINDRANATH

THE MAHARASHTRA CHRONICLE PUNE WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 15, 2018

94 CRORE DRAINED IN TRANS-NATIONAL CYBER HEIST AT COSMOS BANK Malware Clones ATM Switch: 12,000 Withdrawals Siphoned in 28 Countries

PHOTO: CCTV Still of Masked Mule at ATM / Cosmos Bank Corporate HQ in Pune "Proxy switch validated fraudulent transactions simultaneously worldwide"

PUNE In India's most sophisticated banking heist, international hackers infiltrated the ATM switch servers of Pune-based Cosmos Co-operative Bank, diverting 94.42 crore within hours.

The perpetrators deployed a rogue switch that bypassed the core banking validation system, authorizing thousands of synchronized Visa

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